Army of Roaches

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Army of Roaches

by Diaspro (IceRosesCrown)

Summary

After being startled first thing in the morning, Valkyrie Durandal finds herself fighting a cockroach in order to recover her room…

Notes

Well, this is gonna sounds super weird but, fr, this happened to me. Like, all you're gonna read. The tweets I put as inspiration for this prove it. Oh, and I think I didn't tweet the little issue with which this ends, but that part also happened…

Anyways, I hope you enjoy and have some fun reading these shenanigans. I wrote five fics using this event, for different fandoms, that is, and this is one with quite a wholesome couple, I believe.

I'll leave links to the other fics in the ending note.
Now please enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

- Inspired by My tweet that inspired this by Diaspro
- Inspired by Second tweet that inspired this by Diaspro
- Inspired by Third tweet that inspired this by Diaspro

It was early morning and the sun had recently risen. Durandal could hear the sound of Rita in the kitchen, already preparing breakfast, but also, there was a constant meowing. It seemed like Stan wanted to wake her up.

She finally opened her eyes and slowly incorporated, only to find Stan sitting next to her legs, his sight fixed on a roach that was *almost* brushing her leg. It was as if the cat was overlooking the bug, to make sure it wouldn't escape nor touch his human.

—Rita!— she called out.

The maid continued her work of neatly putting together Durandal's meal as she replied — Yes, Master Durandal?

—Do we have something for roaches!?

Her tone was the tiniest bit nervous, yet it was enough to have Rita at the door within seconds, a can of insecticide for cockroaches in hand, and a murderous look.

—Please leave the room immediately, Master Durandal.

Her tone was calm but the Valkyrie perfectly knew that deadly stare. As soon as she was out, with Stan following her closely, Rita closed the door and the sound of the spray-can could be heard for a minute. Shortly after, the maid left the room and gave her that signature smile of hers.

—Thank you, Rita.

—Worry not, Master Durandal. That roach will soon be dead. Please wait a couple of hours and I'll restore your room— she assured her.

—It's alright, I can clean up my room once it's safe to enter.

—Uh? Are you sure, Master Durandal?

—Absolutely. Leave it to me.

After an hour or so, the maid reopened the room so it could air out and Stan entered immediately. He remained there for hours, seemingly reclaiming the territory the roach had stolen from him. As there was still some remaining insecticide in the air, both Durandal and Rita tried to get him out, yet he refused to move a single inch.

They couldn't understand how he was able to breathe there, but he was too stubborn and they had to give up.

After finishing her training for the day, Durandal took a bath and finally went to deal with the roach in her room. However, it wasn't anywhere to be seen. Stan remained on his spot, only following her with his sight as the Valkyrie looked around.

Was the roach actually dead? It *had* to be, there's no way it would survive that much insecticide.

But she couldn't find it.

So, what if it wasn't dead? If she moved something and it came out running, she'd probably freak out again. She could simply change the bedsheets, as Rita had to spray the roach on them, and it'd be ready for her to sleep again, yet she feared the bug would come out of hiding at night and, once again, walk over her.

No, no. There's no way she can spend the night there without being sure it was dead. If she didn't see it completely knocked out, her brain would stay alert and she wouldn't be able to rest at all.

That night, while they were having dinner, Rita remembered the issue.

—Were you able to clean your room, Master Durandal? Remember it's dangerous to sleep in that bed without changing the sheets. You could be affected by the remaining poison in it.

The Valkyrie hesitated a moment, a bit embarrassed.

—I… I couldn't find it. The roach, I mean— she began. —What if it's still alive and it suddenly comes out running while I'm cleaning?

—There's no way it survived, Master Durandal. Please trust me— Rita assured her with a gentle tone.

—I can't be sure— she insisted. —I keep thinking it will appear on my bed again if I sleep there without having found it and seen it's dead— she admitted.

The maid found it so amusing she couldn't help but giggle. Sometimes, she could be very childish which was quite endearing.

—I can do it for you, Master Durandal.

—No, please. I need to be able to do at least this, Rita. You already do a lot for me— she replied.

So that was it…

—In that case, you're always welcome to sleep in my room, Master Durandal— she offered.

—A-are you sure? I don't want to bother you!

—It’s no trouble at all— she replied with a smile. —I only want to ensure you have a full night of rest.

The Valkyrie let out a long sigh. She really didn’t want to be a burden for the maid, but she had no other choice, did she? Sleeping on the couch would hurt her back and she wouldn’t be able to train the next day.

—Fine, thank you very much— she finally accepted.

Durandal went to sleep shortly after and Rita left on an urgent mission. When she arrived some hours later, she found the Valkyrie deep asleep, Stan curled up next to her head, and the sheets kicked off the bed.

After getting ready to sleep, the maid picked up the sheets and gently covered her again. Finally, she lay next to her on the empty side of the mattress and soon fell asleep too.

The next morning, Rita woke up early as usual, yet she couldn't get up. She found Durandal still sound asleep but now tightly cuddling her. The maid couldn't bring herself to disturb her, so she chose to stay in bed until the Valkyrie woke up. It couldn’t possibly hurt to get up a bit later.

The moment she first stirred, Rita softly said —Good morning, Master Durandal.

A large mass of blond hair moved slowly and a groggy voice replied —Morning…

She eventually opened her eyes and little by little took in her surroundings, remembering she wasn't in her room but in Rita’s. And now, she realized how she had been snuggling her.

The Valkyrie immediately blushed in embarrassment, yet Rita only smiled at her, giggling. She was about to apologize, but the maid interrupted her.

—Don't worry, Master Durandal. I don't mind.

—I- Ahem… Still, I’m sorry, Rita. I shouldn't have…— she nervously let out. —Besides, I’ve delayed your schedule— she realized.

—It’s no problem at all, Master Durandal. Rest assured, I still have plenty of time to fulfill my duties— she insisted.

Now that she let go of Rita, they could both begin their morning routines. However, the maid didn't immediately leave. Instead, she looked back at the flustered Valkyrie and briefly kissed her cheek. Once again, she gave her a gentle smile and then set off to start her duties.

Durandal took her time to prepare herself for the day; once dressed and freshened up, she went to have breakfast. Rita had to leave soon, but the Valkyrie hadn’t received any orders and her next training was still in a few hours, so she decided to try and find the roach.

Once again, Stan sat on his spot, observing as Durandal hesitantly moved things around trying to find it. Yet, after a long while, there was still nothing. It was frustrating, but she wouldn't give up; for now, at least, she could take off the bedsheets and have them washed so they would be ready for that night.

After her training, she returned to the house and took a bath. Rita was nowhere to be found again, but there was a bento box waiting for her in the kitchen. She quickly had lunch and gathered her courage to go and look for the roach.

It had become increasingly frustrating for her: everything she moved made her shiver with the possibility of seeing the roach suddenly come out running from under it; every noise she heard and couldn't identify made her think it was that bug moving somewhere. Stan kept his position while the Valkyrie gradually searched the room to no avail.

By the time Rita arrived, Carbon Stalker in tow, she found her resting on the couch, defeated. She stifled a giggle and gently approached her.

—Good evening, Master Durandal. How was your day?

—It beat me, Rita. I can't find it— she replied, groaning.

The maid let out a smile and requested —Please let me take care of this, Master Durandal.

The Valkyrie sat properly on the couch and refused —No, please. I have to be able to handle my own room, Rita. I appreciate all you do for me, but I can't depend on you for everything.

The maid found it so endearing she couldn't bring herself to insist so, instead, she offered —May I just remove the roach so you can recover your room?

Durandal stared at her in disbelief for a moment, surprised that she's actually encouraging her with this little bit of independence she wants to have.

—Thank you, Rita— she gently replied.

The maid looked at Carbon Stalker and he immediately ran into Durandal's room. Stan fled almost immediately, and within a minute, the mechanic dog was out of the room.

—He found and disposed of it, Master Durandal. The room is all yours— she assured her.

—Oh… that was quick— she muttered.

That night, the Valkyrie slept in her room once again. She may not be as good as Rita at making bed nor does it have that aroma of clean clothes she liked so much, but *she* had done it. Part of her missed that care for details from the maid, but she was also glad to lift this burden from her, even if it's just a small one.

The following night, they were both having dinner and discussing their day.

—… but I don't understand how the Immortal Blades learned about the issue with the cockroach!

—Oh, I may have mentioned it the other day. I didn't think you'd mind, Master Durandal.

—Ah, that makes sense. In that case, it's alright, I was just surprised when Alvitr asked about it.

—Good thing it's settled now— Rita smiled.

—Indeed— she agreed. —We've had complicated missions that lasted even less than this, I'm not used to losing to something so small— she admitted, visibly upset.

—It may have won several battles, but you did win the war, Master Durandal.

—More like *you* did— she corrected her. —Even dead, I couldn't find it!

—Well, you did recover your room, no?— Rita insisted, wanting to encourage her.

—I did— she laughed. —Although… Alvitr said that now, it's wife and children are planning revenge.

The Valkyrie looked so serious when she said it that the maid couldn't keep herself from laughing.

—Master Durandal, you wouldn't believe that to be true, would you?

—No warning should be ignored, Rita.

The maid no longer knew what or how to reply when it was clear the Valkyrie *was* taking it seriously, so she preferred to change subjects while they finished their dinner.

Within an hour, both of them had retired to their respective rooms. Durandal comfortably laid in bed, hoping sleep would come soon, but the murmur of something noisy being brushed or perhaps scratched, kept disturbing her.

—Stan!— she called out, sure he was scratching or biting something of hers. She heard him jump down and supposed that would be it, so she returned to try and sleep. However, she heard it again shortly after, and exclaimed —Stan! Stop!—. Yet a moment later, she heard it once again. Stan could be annoying, but that was too much. Besides, she could have sworn he had to be sleeping at her feet. So the next time she heard it and verified Stan was, undoubtedly, sleeping at her feet, she got up and turned on the lights. —No way…— she sighed, nervous again.

She hated having to do this, but there was no other option. After knocking barely once on Rita's door, the maid opened immediately, seemingly ready to go out on a mission if necessary.

—Is there any trouble, Master Durandal?

—Please come— she begged her. Once they were both inside the room, she explained —I heard a sound and thought it was Stan playing with something, but it kept sounding and I noticed Stan was sleeping, so… The sounds seem to come from that high closet, and it may be another roach.

Rita's demeanor suddenly changed.

—Alright, Master Durandal— she began. —Please take everything you need and make yourself comfortable in my room. I'll take care of this— she assured her.

Durandal didn't lose a second; she grabbed her clothes, footwear, and Stan, then promptly left the room. In the meantime, Rita waited for the scratching sound Durandal had mentioned; once she heard it, she knew which of the upper closets it came from, and went for the insecticide.

Meanwhile, the Valkyrie sat on Rita's bed, sighing deeply. Part of her was perhaps worried that Alvitr had been right, but mainly, she was disheartened because, once again, she had needed Rita to solve her problems.

The maid is always glad to help her with everything she might need and doesn't consider her a charge. On the contrary, she enjoys being of use to her, but even if Durandal knows it, she still wishes she could do more for her in return.

Soon, Rita arrived at the room and interrupted her thoughts.

—Thank you, *again*.

—Worry not, Master Durandal— she immediately replied. —I have sprayed insecticide in all upper closets, if there is one or more roaches, they won't survive, I can assure you— she continued. Finally, with a gentle smile, she concluded —Please spend the night here so the poison from the insecticide won't affect you.

—I- Ah… of course, Rita. Thank you— she accepted. The maid left to prepare herself for bed and Durandal laid down. She stared at the ceiling, reflecting on what she could say, and how, once Rita returned. After a while, she let out a long sigh and sat on the edge of the bed when she heard the maid approaching. —Rita… I can't properly express how grateful I am for everything you do for me, but I don't wish to be a burden to you. If there's any way in which I can repay you all of this…

—Please, Master Durandal. There's no need— she interrupted. —I only fulfill my duties as your adjutant as I always have.

—Organizing my training and handling my meals for proper calorie intake is one thing. Having to fix every single problem of mine, to the point of giving up your privacy like this… You have no obligation, Rita. I could sleep on the couch, yet you're sharing with me what's yours, I don't…

—Master Durandal— she interrupted again, grabbing her hands this time. —There's no need to apologize or further thank me— she began, her tone soothing. —I can see this is making you nervous, so let me assure you: I enjoy helping you like this—. She smiled brightly and the Valkyrie felt part of her tension ease. —And waking up with you cuddling me was quite nice too— she added, giggling.

Durandal's face flushed intensely, but she couldn't even pull her hands from Rita's.

—I-I'm relieved it didn't, um… make you uncomfortable.

—Not in the slightest— she smiled. —You're welcome to do it again.

The Valkyrie didn't think she could get even more embarrassed, yet there she was, feeling her face burn. But she couldn't let go of such an opportunity either.

Morning found them comfortably hugging. Rita gently held Durandal's head next to her chest, while the Valkyrie tightly hugged the maid's waist. They woke up at the same time, feeling rested and calm, and helped each other with their morning routines.

They decided, from that day on, to share some of the chores, like making breakfast, so Durandal could help Rita, which allowed the maid to fulfill all her duties as usual, while making some of them easier or, at least, more enjoyable.

But the Valkyrie still wanted to handle her own room, and decided to fully clean it, making sure no more roaches would bother her any time soon. She began tidying her room that day, wanting to remove most things so no corner would be left unchecked, and half her things were out by nightfall.

Once again, she had her room back, so she enjoyed a peaceful night, and woke up bright and early to help Rita with breakfast. Later, they left the house for their respective jobs, and only Durandal returned home for lunch; Rita sent her a message reminding her that her meal was on the fridge, so the Valkyrie sat to enjoy the food for a while.

Hours later, she was putting away the last things she needed to remove from her room, while Stan came and go, occasionally meowing at her. It seemed like he was trying to tell her something, but this time it couldn't be a roach again because he was moving much more.

Yet he did have something very important he wished he could tell her.

Rita was on her way to speak with Amber, who requested her presence as soon as possible, but had to change her plans. She received a message from Durandal: a picture from her

room’s floor and rooftop.

Within an hour, the maid was standing next to the Valkyrie, both looking at the ceiling while Stan stared at them, visibly offended for having been ignored for so long. He had spent the whole day trying to tell her human that the roof was falling little by little, but she only noticed when a piece bigger than her hand fell down.

Rita silently looked down at the bits of material spread on the floor before finally letting out —Please, Master Durandal. Do me a favor and temporarily move into my room—. She then looked up at her and, with a smile that hid a bit of murderous intent, added —I’ll inform the Overseer we need urgent reparations here.

End Notes

Yes. A piece of my ceiling fell down.
Also, everything Stan does here is what my cat did. ~~But she's not a honkai beast lol~~

Now, I hope you had fun and, in case you wanna read the other versions of this, if you like the other fandoms, here are the links:

Genshin Impact: Jeanlisa version
She-Ra (2018): Catradora version, Glimbow version, Castaweaver version

Thank you all for reading!!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!